ROUND 1 OF 6
Hosted by Roll 27

100 POINTS

War Dogs (2016) is based on a true story. How much was the real Pentagon contract that AEY Inc. won?

A $3 million

B $29.8 million

C $298 million

D $2.98 billion

Hands up: A, B, C or D?

WHO WANTS TO BE A CRIMINOLOGIST? · WAR DOGS EDITION · GROUP 6

CORRECT ANSWER

C **$298 million: a real 2007 contract to arm the Afghan National Army**

THE FILM

Directed by Todd Phillips (Warner Bros., 2016). Jonah Hill as Efraim Diveroli, Miles Teller as David Packouz, Bradley Cooper as broker Henry Girard.

ACT I · THE HUSTLE

Broke Miami masseur David joins Efraim's company AEY, bidding online for small Pentagon contracts, then pushes a stuck shipment through Jordan into Iraq.

ACT II · THE DEAL

Watch-listed broker Henry opens access to old ammunition in Albania. AEY underbids everyone and wins the Afghan contract.

ACT III · THE FALL

The rounds are Chinese-made and banned. They are repackaged to hide it. Efraim: 4 years in prison; David: 7 months house arrest.

Organized crime doesn't always carry guns. Sometimes it sells them, with a government contract.

Sources: Phillips (2016); Lawson (2015).

200 POINTS

Under the UN Convention against Transnational Organized Crime, is AEY an “organized criminal group”?

A No, it was a legally registered company

B No, it had fewer than three people

C Yes: 3+ people, over time, serious crime, for profit

D Only if it used violence

Hands up: A, B, C or D?

CORRECT ANSWER

C **Yes. Under UNTOC Article 2, AEY is an organized criminal group**

THE UN TEST (UNODC, 2004)

A structured group of 3+ persons, existing for a period of time, acting together to commit serious crime for material benefit. AEY ticks every box.

ABADINSKY'S MAFIA TEST (2013)

Hierarchy, exclusive membership, rituals, survival after arrests: AEY has none of these. It collapsed when its leaders were charged.

OUR CLASSIFICATION

Organized white-collar crime: a legal company committing organized fraud (Sutherland, 1940).

TRANSNATIONAL

The crime spanned the US, Jordan, Iraq, Albania and Afghanistan, exploiting gaps between national laws.

Sources: UNODC (2004); Abadinsky (2013); Sutherland (1940).

300 POINTS

AEY started legally and slid into fraud as demand grew. Which model of organized crime fits best?

A Hierarchical model (Cressey)

B Patron–client model (Albini)

C Enterprise model (Smith)

D The traditional mafia “family”

Hands up: A, B, C or D?

CORRECT ANSWER

C **Enterprise model: crime as business on a legal–illegal spectrum**

ENTERPRISE · SMITH (1980) · STRONG FIT
Legal and illegal business sit on one spectrum, driven by the same demand. AEY moved from bidding, to fixers, to fraud.

NETWORK · MORSELLI (2009) · STRONG FIT
Brokers who connect separate worlds hold the power: AEY linked the Pentagon to Henry, Henry to Albania.

PATRON–CLIENT · ALBINI (1971) · PARTIAL
Henry acts as a patron, trading access to supply for a share of the profits.

HIERARCHICAL · CRESSEY (1969) · WEAK
No ranks, no code, no family: everything rested on Efraim alone.

Sources: Smith (1980); Morselli (2009); Albini (1971); Cressey (1969).

500 POINTS

Klitgaard's famous formula says Corruption = M + D − A. What do M, D and A stand for?

A Money + Drugs − Arrests

B Mafia + Deals − Audits

C Monopoly + Discretion − Accountability

D Motive + Desire − Anxiety

Hands up: A, B, C or D?

CORRECT ANSWER

C **Monopoly + Discretion − Accountability (Klitgaard, 1988)**

MONOPOLY
Henry controls the only access to cheap Balkan ammunition, so everyone in the chain must pay him.

DISCRETION
Officials, fixers and border agents in Jordan and Albania decide with little scrutiny; middlemen skim profits.

LOW ACCOUNTABILITY
In wartime urgency, a company run by a man in his early twenties passes Pentagon vetting.

STATE-CORPORATE CRIME
Corruption is the abuse of entrusted power for private gain. Here the harm grew from a policy of outsourcing war to the lowest bidder (Kramer et al., 2002).

Sources: Klitgaard (1988); Transparency International (n.d.); Kramer et al. (2002).

1,000 POINTS

“The troops still get bullets that work. Who is harmed?” This excuse is an example of which technique of neutralization?

A. Denial of injury

B. Denial of the victim

C. Condemnation of the condemners

D. Appeal to higher loyalties

Hands up: A, B, C or D?

CORRECT ANSWER

A **Denial of injury: “no one is really hurt” (Sykes & Matza, 1957)**

NEUTRALIZATION · SYKES & MATZA (1957)
Offenders know the rules but switch them off: denial of injury, “the government does it too”, “I did it for my family”.

STRAIN / ANOMIE · MERTON (1938)
Broke, with a baby coming, David “innovates”: legitimate goal of wealth, illegitimate means. Money overrides family (Messner & Rosenfeld, 1994).

DIFFERENTIAL ASSOCIATION · SUTHERLAND (1940)
David learns both the methods and the excuses of fraud from Efraim.

RATIONAL CHOICE · CORNISH & CLARKE (1986)
Repackaging banned rounds: a huge reward against a small chance of being caught.

Paraphrased excuses reflect the characters’ attitudes; they are not verbatim lines.

Sources: Sykes & Matza (1957); Merton (1938); Messner & Rosenfeld (1994); Sutherland (1940); Cornish & Clarke (1986).

1 MILLION POINTS

The million-point question: how accurately does War Dogs portray organized crime and corruption?

A Completely accurate, like a documentary

B Accurate in substance, exaggerated in style

C Pure fiction with no basis in fact

D It makes the fraud look worse than it was

Hands up: A, B, C or D?

ROUND 6 OF 6
Hosted by Roll 21

CORRECT ANSWER

B Accurate in substance, exaggerated in style: our final verdict

WHAT IT GETS RIGHT

Breaks the mafia stereotype; fits the UN definition, enterprise and network models; the contract, repackaging and sentences are real.

WHAT IT GETS WRONG

Comedy glamorizes fraud; Henry is a composite; the threats in Albania are invented; it skips the Gërdec depot blast that killed 26 in 2008.

OUR CONCLUSION

AEY is organized crime under the UN definition, but not the mafia: organized white-collar crime, enabled by a weak system.

LESSON FOR BANGLADESH

Big procurement relies on middlemen too. Vet contractors, disclose real owners and check where goods come from.

Thank you for playing! Every contestant wins. Questions?

Sources: Lawson (2015); Al Jazeera (2008). Verdict is the group's assessment.